



PROGRESS REPORT

Eritrea: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-07 · 51 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-07.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The sector rests on a 1998 communications proclamation and its regulations; the only sectoral policy named is for education. The base holds no national digital or ICT strategy for this country. What it holds instead is the sector's legal furniture, listed in a country profile and not held as text: Communications Proclamation 102 of 1998, which set the legal basis for communications, the Regulations on Telecommunications Networks and Services issued as Legal Notice 43 of 1998, and a 2003 proclamation establishing the state telecommunications corporation . The one sector-specific policy named anywhere is a National Policy for ICT in Education setting goals for connectivity, ministry systems, staff training and school use of technology . The 2018-2022 National Education Sector Plan carries it forward, aiming at technology infrastructure and e-learning options, on the back of an ICT in education initiative the ministry launched in January 2005 . The sector plan states its own result: incorporating technology in education remains difficult for want of facilities, equipment and teacher training . Neither the policy nor the plan is held as a document, and the profile carrying them is a legacy platform its publisher states is no longer updated.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A national action plan to domesticate the UN geospatial information framework is the first interoperability roadmap on the base (action plan). Eritrea produced a national action plan in April 2026 to domesticate the United Nations Integrated Geospatial Information Framework, intended to improve the integration and interoperability of geospatial information and national data systems (action plan). The position it moves from is comprehensive absence: a 2022 structured assessment records no government enterprise architecture framework, no government interoperability framework, no data quality framework and no government service bus platform (dataset). The plan is geospatial in scope rather than whole-of-government, and the base holds no adoption date, budget or implementing body for it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The government scores zero on policy capacity in the 2025 artificial-intelligence readiness index, ranking 193rd (index). The government artificial-intelligence readiness index for 2025, updated in January 2026 across 195 governments, scores Eritrea zero on policy capacity and ranks it 193rd overall on 13.69 (index). The index awards a national strategy score only for a published strategy or a published draft, and Eritrea has neither. A June 2026 legal-status review records the same absence from the legal side: no national artificial-intelligence strategy (review). The base does hold one AI system in state hands — an agricultural expert system inside a ministry information system — so the absence is of policy, not of the technology.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	The geospatial framework action plan is the first data-governance instrument on the base (action plan). The April 2026 action plan to domesticate the geospatial information framework covers governance arrangements for national geospatial data, the first instrument of its kind on the base (action plan). Against it, a 2022 structured assessment records no data quality framework and no system exchanging data across financial management, human resources, payroll, customs, tax or social insurance (dataset), and there is no data-protection law or authority (redetermination). A sectoral plan is not a national data-governance policy, and nothing on the base claims one exists.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	A verification pass dated August 2026 confirms no comprehensive data-protection law in force (redetermination). A dated redetermination as of 1 August 2026 confirms the position is unchanged: no comprehensive data-protection law in force, no supervisory authority established and no enforcement decisions published (redetermination). A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight, grouped with Djibouti, South Sudan and Sudan against neighbours that have enacted frameworks with supervisory authorities (policy matrix). A trade regulatory profile records that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework for data protection, with no data-protection officer, impact-assessment or retention requirements (profile). This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one: three independent assessments across four years agree.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	Computer offences sit in two articles of the general Penal Code; no dedicated cybersecurity statute exists (Penal Code). Eritrea's only identifiable computer-offence provisions are Articles 374 and 375 of the 2015 Penal Code, covering unauthorised use of a computer — unauthorised access, interception, alteration or destruction of data, interference with lawful data use — and an aggravated form (Penal Code). A country cybersecurity assessment records, item by item, no cybercrime legislation, no cybersecurity regulation, no officially recognised national computer incident response team, no national cybersecurity strategy, no governance roadmap and no responsible agency (assessment). Nothing in the window changed either position. Criminal provisions exist; the institutional apparatus a cybersecurity regime needs does not. Nor is there a strategy behind the missing statute: a country profile records no public national cybersecurity strategy, so neither the legislative nor the policy layer exists on the record.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	No digital-identity statute exists; the closest instrument is the 1992 nationality proclamation (proclamation). No dedicated digital-identity statute was located. The closest identifiable legal instrument is the Nationality Proclamation 21/1992, still in force, which provides the legal basis for nationality certification through the Department of Internal Affairs and contains no digital-identity, electronic-identity, biometric or electronic-transactions framework (proclamation). Identity cards are nonetheless required by other systems: anti-money-laundering law obliges financial institutions to identify every customer (proclamation), and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (country guidance). So the card carries statutory weight without a statute defining it, and nothing regulates what data it holds or who may read it.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	A regional peer assessment records a state-owned financial system with no cash machines, cards or internet banking (evaluation). A regional anti-money-laundering peer assessment, adopted in July 2025 after an on-site visit in 2024, states that Eritrea's financial system is state-owned and offers simple and less sophisticated services, with no automatic teller machines, debit or credit cards, or internet banking (evaluation). There is therefore nothing for payments legislation to regulate, and the base holds no payment systems act, no e-money regulation and no licensing regime. The only draft text addressing digital finance is an unofficial consultation draft (drafts). The one instrument on the ledger is a central bank legal notice ordering cash deposits, which is currency management rather than payments law.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No law enables data exchange between government systems; a 2022 assessment records no service bus and no cross-system exchange (dataset). A structured government-technology dataset for 2022 records no government interoperability framework and no system that exchanges data across financial management, human resources, payroll, customs, tax or social-insurance systems (dataset). A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight (policy matrix), so there is also no legal basis on which systems could lawfully share personal data. The one system that did move is closed rather than connected: the customs platform runs on an intranet architecture independent of continuous internet access (account).	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	A review dated June 2026 records no dedicated artificial-intelligence law and no national strategy (review). A legal-status review dated 8 June 2026 states that Eritrea has no dedicated artificial-intelligence law, no national artificial-intelligence strategy, no data-protection statute and no data-protection authority, and that the nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 constitution, which has never entered into force (review). The 2025 government artificial-intelligence readiness index, in its January 2026 edition, scores Eritrea zero on policy capacity and ranks it 193rd overall on a score of 13.69 (index). The absence is total rather than partial: no instrument, no draft and no institution with a mandate.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	No electronic transactions framework is in force; the only relevant texts are unofficial consultation drafts (drafts). A diaspora legal-reform initiative published around eighty consultation-draft acts, codes and regulations intended to reconstruct Eritrea's legal order, including a proposed commercial code and a payment systems and digital finance act addressing electronic transactions (drafts). These are unofficial and carry no legislative status. The standing assessment is that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework in the digital-trade area, with the only body holding sector-supervision power having little to no decision-making authority (profile). Nothing on the base records a government bill, a consultation or a stated intention to legislate on electronic transactions.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The statistics office has never operated under an enacted statistics law; a draft proclamation was recorded as pending (review). A mid-term review of statistical capacity support records that the statistical proclamation, the equivalent of a statistics act, had been submitted to government and that the formal issue was still pending (review). No later record of enactment was located at the probe date of 31 August 2026, so the national statistics office has operated for at least two decades without a statutory mandate. This matters for the surveys the base does hold: a population and health survey was carried out without a law defining who owns the data, who may access it or on what terms it is published.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	No freedom of information law has been adopted, a UN review body states plainly (review contribution). A formal contribution to Eritrea's universal periodic review states that no freedom of information law has been adopted, and that the constitutional guarantee of access to information sits in a 1997 constitution whose operative reality is the 1996 press proclamation (review contribution). The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year (index). The absence is legislative and practical at once: there is no statute, no request procedure and no appeal route, so nothing measures how much information is released.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	Data protection authority		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	National data protection readiness	No supervisory authority exists and none is provided for; the position was re-verified in August 2026 (redetermination). The August 2026 verification pass records no comprehensive data-protection law, no supervisory authority and no published enforcement decisions (redetermination). The only body with sector-supervision power is the Communication Department, which a trade regulatory profile describes as having little to no decision-making authority (profile). The nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 Constitution, which has never been brought into force (legal status). Readiness here is not partial: there is no law, no regulator and no route to redress.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Regional planning still treats Eritrea as a gap: cable and data-infrastructure projects carry no commitment to serve Asmara (overview). A regional digital development overview records that planned submarine and festoon cable and regional data-infrastructure projects lack a commitment to serve the region as a whole, including Asmara (overview). The regional infrastructure master plan treats Eritrea as a connectivity gap whose interconnection to Sudan, Ethiopia or submarine landing points should be implemented in the short term – language describing a planned solution rather than an existing connection, and Eritrea is not listed as an existing landing point (master plan). Six years on from that plan the base still holds no cable landing and no cross-border interconnection.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National quality standards	Standardisation rests on the 1995 proclamation establishing the standards institution as sole national organ (proclamation). The Eritrean Standards Institution was established by proclamation in 1995 as an autonomous body with legal personality and the sole national organ for standardisation, quality assurance and metrology, with powers to prepare compulsory Eritrean standards, affix conformity marks, test and certify import and export products, and inspect (proclamation). Nothing in the window amended that proclamation, and the base holds no Eritrean standard made under it that bears on digital systems, data formats or interoperability. The institution exists and its output in this field is not on the record.	NO CHANGE
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The 1995 standards proclamation adopts the international system of units as the legal measurement system (proclamation). The proclamation establishing the Eritrean Standards Institution expressly adopts the International System of Units as Eritrea's legal measurement system (proclamation). A structured government-technology dataset for 2022 records no government enterprise architecture framework, no government interoperability framework and no data quality framework (dataset). So metrology is aligned to international standards and government data practice is not; nothing on the base records adoption of an international standard for identity, payments or data exchange.	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	Technical workshops in Asmara brought government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants into planning for the first time on the base (workshops). A water project held two rounds of geodesign workshops in Asmara in July 2026 with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants, using a geodesign platform with high-resolution hydrological modelling for two catchments, alongside a modelling training session for Eritrean technical experts (workshops). Eritrea completed its first national development plan, described as drafted through participatory, gender-responsive and results-based methods with cross-ministerial and stakeholder consultation (annual report). Both accounts are the conveners' own descriptions of process, not independent evidence of influence, and they sit against a state that systematically silences criticism (findings).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	A press-freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 for the third consecutive year (index). The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year, alongside China and North Korea, describing a state of press freedom that has hardly changed (index). A United Nations commission of inquiry found that the government systematically silences anyone who protests, questions or criticises it and its policy, and that surveillance and punishment produce self-censorship even in private and family settings (findings). There is no forum on the record — no independent press, no permitted civil society, no online space — in which digital or data policy could be publicly argued.	NO CHANGE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A development bank mission in April 2026 reopened dialogue on a prospective financial-sector modernisation project (mission). A development bank delegation led by its East Africa director general met the senior adviser to the president and the finance minister in April 2026, with line-ministry discussions covering financial-sector modernisation and data systems, and both sides reviewing continued dialogue on a prospective project (mission). The standing umbrella instrument is the 2022-2026 cooperation framework with the United Nations development system, which provides for an "improved and integrated data ecosystem", innovation and digital technology, and public-finance support (framework). That framework expires in 2026 and the base holds no successor.	ADVANCED
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	UNDP's statistical-capacity grant to the National Statistics Office runs to 2026 and is the only development-partner financing on the ledger. The standing position is a US\$1,676,837 UNDP grant to the Government of Eritrea and the National Statistics Office, committed in 2019 with an end year of 2026 . Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 records a disbursement, an extension or a successor, and no second development partner appears anywhere on this ledger. The grant funds the statistical work reported under Censuses and surveys, so what movement there is shows up there rather than here.	NO CHANGE

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Active connections reached 859,000, or 23.7% of the population, up 8.2% year on year, among the lowest rates in Africa. 2025-11-08 — DataReportal's Digital 2026 report for Eritrea puts active mobile connections at 859,000, 23.7% of the population, 49.3% of them broadband, and up 8.2% on the year . The previous edition is the comparison. The direction is upward and the level is among the lowest in Africa. Both statements are true, and the second governs what sits downstream of it: a foundational digital ID, mobile money and any service assumed to reach a citizen through a handset all rest on this figure. No operator or regulator return on the ledger tests it. Coverage is separately reported and much higher than connections: 85% of the population is covered by a mobile-cellular network but only 35% by at least third-generation service and 0% by at least fourth-generation , on 2023 international figures. Nearly a quarter of the population holds a connection inside a network that reaches five-sixths of them.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Internet usage	About 27% of the population uses the internet, with fixed broadband subscriptions effectively negligible. A country profile carries the 2023 international telecommunication union figures: 85% of the population covered by a mobile-cellular network, 35% by at least third-generation service and 0% by at least fourth-generation, with fixed broadband subscriptions effectively negligible , and puts internet use at about 27% of the population on a separate estimate . Coverage and use are two different numbers here and the gap between them is the finding. Five-sixths of the population live inside a mobile-cellular signal, about a third inside one carrying third-generation data and none inside fourth-generation , while about a quarter use the internet at all. With no public submarine cable landing station, the operator's internet connectivity relies on geostationary satellite links , which is the ceiling under all three. These are first figures for this base with nothing earlier behind them, so no direction can be stated.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	An entry-level mobile broadband basket costs 85% of monthly income per head, against a 2% affordability benchmark (country tables). Country-table data on 2022 pricing records Eritrea's entry-level mobile broadband basket at 85% of monthly gross national income per head, against the international affordability benchmark of 2% (country tables). That is more than forty times the benchmark, and no later Eritrea-specific figure was located at the probe date, so the base cannot say whether it has moved since 2022. The level is stated and the direction is withheld, because there is nothing to compare it against. The operator's own published terms are the only prices the base holds directly: a fixed telephone line costs a one-time payment of 882 nakfa on top of a written request, an application form and a copy of the identity card, and prepaid mobile recharge is sold in denominations of 110 and 330 nakfa , recharged by a dialled code . No tariff per minute or per gigabyte is published.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The ministry reports about 73km of new cable laid and landline plant renovated in six towns; no independent measure of the backbone exists. 2026-05-19 — the minister responsible for communications reported 184 towers installed, about 73km of new cable laid, and landline plant renovated in six named towns and at the Naval Force Base , against a claimed cumulative investment above 35 billion Nakfa. The figures are the ministry's own, carried by state media, and nothing on the ledger tests them: no operator disclosure, no regulator return and no third-party measurement of the network appears for Eritrea in the window. EriTel remains the sole operator.	ADVANCED on the ministry's own figures
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	Bandwidth is reported at about 1,536 Mbps after a decade of growth, and it is carried by satellite: no submarine cable lands in Eritrea. 2026-05-19 — the ministry put international bandwidth at about 1,536 Mbps, risen over the past decade . 2026-04-16 — the industry position is unchanged: Eritrea is still the only one of Africa's coastal states with no cable landing , and cable firms describe a country that does not answer landing requests. An earlier account of the same position dates it to June 2024. EriTel's international transit therefore runs on geostationary satellite, which is what a bandwidth figure of this size describes. The growth is real and the ceiling is the technology carrying it.	ADVANCED on a ministry figure, with no cable landing behind it
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Starlink lists Eritrea with no planned launch date, one of seven African states without a timetable; the base holds no licence application or refusal. 2026-07-17 — Starlink's own availability map still lists Eritrea as having no planned launch date , leaving it one of seven African states with no announced timetable, all of them in North Africa and the Horn. The position is the one the base carried at the start of the window. What is not on the ledger is any Eritrean decision: no application, no refusal and no regulatory statement about satellite broadband appears, so the absence is recorded from the operator's side only.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	There is no public national cybersecurity strategy; the one recorded incident is a government announcement. A country profile records that Eritrea has no public national cybersecurity strategy . The single incident on record is the state's own account of it: in May 2024 the government publicly announced that the country's internet system had been hit by what it called a massive cyberattack, repelled without service interruption . No incident detail, attribution, response body or computer emergency response team is named, and nothing independent corroborates either the attack or its repulse. That is the whole of what this base holds on cybersecurity for the country - one stated absence and one unverifiable claim.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The identity card is required to open a telephone line - the one documented use of it by another system. With no foundational digital identity system in service, there is no digital credential for another system to consume. What the base can show is the paper card being used as a precondition: the state operator requires, for a fixed telephone line, a written request with address and contact number, a completed application form, a copy of the identity card and a one-time payment of 882 nakfa . That is a documentary check at a counter, not an authentication against a register, and it runs the wrong way round from what this indicator asks: the card gates access to a service rather than a service verifying against an identity system. It is the only such link the base holds. The other established dependency is internal to the state: a national identity document is required before an Eritrean passport can be issued .	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Standards-based exchange between health systems is rated not there, and patient-level systems do not interoperate with routine reporting (assessment). A health-data capacity assessment records explicitly that interoperability – standards-based data exchange between systems – is rated not there, and that patient-level systems are not interoperable with the aggregated routine health information system (assessment). A nationally owned health-data programme was launched around the 2025 population and health survey, led by the statistics office and the health ministry, intended to produce timely disaggregated evidence accessible to government and partners (case study). A survey programme is not interoperability. Nothing on the base records a standard adopted, an exchange built or a patient identifier shared between systems.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	A teacher management information system remains planned, with a ministry delegation sent to learn the practice (workshop). An education ministry delegation attended a regional competency enhancement workshop in Lusaka in June 2025, reported in December, to learn teacher management information system practice (workshop). The education sector reform compact of September 2023 is the operative planning document behind the education management information system, which it says was used to identify barriers and prioritise reforms, and it names a teacher management information system as a planned enabling instrument (compact). Both systems are described in planning documents and neither is shown exchanging data with anything else; the teacher system is still a plan three years on.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	A vulnerability database was established in the labour ministry; nothing states it exchanges data with any other system (results report). United Nations support helped the labour and human welfare ministry establish a vulnerability database to collect, collate and analyse gender-segregated data on persons with disabilities, single-women-headed households and other vulnerable groups (results report). The report does not state that the database exchanges data with the population registers, the health information system or any payment mechanism, and a 2022 structured assessment records no system exchanging data across social insurance or payroll (dataset). So the base holds one database and no exchange, which is the whole of what can be said.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position with nothing on exchange
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The base holds no operational foundational digital ID, a position profiled in July 2025 and untouched since. 2025-07-26 — a digital identity index profile found no operational foundational identity system and set out what one would face: low connectivity and mobile penetration, thin digital infrastructure, a telecom monopoly and weak civil registration. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 changes that. No enrolment programme, procurement, pilot or legal instrument on digital identity appears on the ledger, so the standing position is carried forward on a single profile written just before the window opened.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	With no foundational digital system in service, the credential is a card issued since 1992, handwritten until 2014. The same 2025-07-26 profile that finds no operational foundational identity system names weak civil registration among the barriers a future one would face, which is the nearest the base comes to a statement about coverage. No enrolment figure exists to report, because there is nothing to enrol into. The population counting the base does hold is the survey work reported under Censuses and surveys, which is a statistical exercise and not a register. The credential that does exist is documented: identity cards are issued by the Department of Immigration and Nationality, were first issued in 1992 and were handwritten until 2014, with applicants submitting a municipality letter, a birth certificate and proof of citizenship to one of twelve branch offices which forward the application to headquarters for approval . A newer electronic card carries a laser-engraved photograph, the holder's fingerprint and a unique serial number , and citizens aged 18 and over are required to hold one . No issuance volume, coverage rate or database behind the card is on record at any date, and the fullest account of the system is eight years old.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	Birth registration feeds the regional population registers, and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (guidance). Operational country guidance published in March 2026 states that Eritrea issues national identity cards and that a national identity document is required before an Eritrean passport can be issued (guidance). Birth registration feeds the zoba population registers through the local family register and transfer documents, and the identity and residence cards are printed extracts of those registers (technical description). The chain therefore exists but is regional rather than national, and the base holds no birth-registration coverage rate, so how many children enter it is not known. What feeds them is not measured: the 2025 vital statistics return leaves birth and death registration completeness blank, and the only structural account, from 2002, records registration under a transitional civil code in eight urban areas only, optional rather than obligatory, kept for administrative purposes with no statistical data retained. An identity layer fed by a registration system of unknown coverage inherits that unknown.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The Bank of Eritrea gave holders of cash outside the banking system until 31 July 2026 to deposit it, on pain of legal action. 2026-07-02 – a legal notice from the Bank of Eritrea ordered cash held outside banks deposited by 31 July 2026, with legal action threatened against holders who do not comply. The notice defines no threshold for the excessive holding it names and states no enforcement mechanism. It is the only central-bank action on this ledger, and it addresses the cash economy rather than any payment system: no named mobile-money or digital-payments service appears anywhere on the base for Eritrea.	ADVANCED an instrument aimed at the cash economy rather than at payment

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Eritrea is absent from the continental inventory of instant payment systems, so no rail exists for government-to-person payment (inventory). The annual continental inventory of live and planned instant payment systems, covering systems with live transactions as of June 2024, does not list Eritrea among the 31 operating systems across 26 countries, and does not identify it among those supporting government-to-person functionality (inventory). The financial system it would run on has no cash machines, cards or internet banking (evaluation). Government payments to people are therefore made in cash, and nothing on the base records a plan to change that.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	There is no digital payment rail of any kind; a modernisation project remains prospective (mission). A development bank delegation visited in April 2026 and reviewed continued dialogue on a prospective financial sector modernisation project, with discussions covering financial-sector modernisation and data systems (mission). The project is prospective, not approved. The system it would modernise has no cash machines, debit or credit cards, or internet banking (evaluation), and Eritrea does not appear in the continental instant-payments inventory (inventory). Person-to-person, person-to-government and person-to-business payment are all cash transactions here, and the base records no exception. The absence was searched again and stands: a sector account of the country's fintech position in March 2026 names no mobile money or digital payments service, records online banking, cash machines and mobile financial applications as largely absent, and puts total online commerce at under US\$10m a year . A dated search finding nothing is a different statement from an unexamined gap, and this is now the second.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	More than 70% of Eritreans are estimated to remain unbanked, with cash dominating economic activity. A trade account of the country's position in 2026 estimates that more than 70% of Eritreans remain unbanked, on a highly centralised financial system of a small number of state-owned banks, one of which provides the majority of retail banking . It links that structure to limited competition, minimal innovation and heavy reliance on manual processes, with online banking, cash machines and mobile financial applications largely absent so cash continues to dominate . The digital economy it would serve is correspondingly small: total online commerce is estimated at under US\$10m a year, and mobile penetration was just under 60% of population in 2022, ranked 191st of 209 economies . These are a trade publication's estimates, not a central bank or survey series, and no official financial inclusion measurement for the country is held at any date. The figure is reported for what it is.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register	Population registration runs on six separate regional registers with no central national register (technical description). Eritrea's population registration has been digital at regional level since 2001: six separate registers, one per zoba, each recording an identity number, family and resident numbers, nationality and civil data, from which residence cards and family identity cards are printed as extracts. Birth registration feeds them through the local family register. There is no central national register (technical description). A regional treaty body, reviewing Eritrea's fourth periodic report in April 2026, recognised the development of a five-year strategic civil registration and vital statistics plan for 2024-2028 (concluding observations). A country-of-origin report carries a dedicated section on the register and the cards drawn from it (report). The base holds no coverage rate and no statement that the six registers reconcile with one another.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	The 2025 vital statistics return leaves registration completeness blank; the only structural account of the system is from 2002. The country's return to the United Nations vital statistics questionnaire for reporting year 2025 leaves the completeness fields for birth and death registration blank , so no registration completeness estimate is reported at all - which is itself the most current statement the base has. The only description of the system's shape is twenty-four years old and is stated as such: birth registration then ran under a transitional civil code in eight named urban areas only and not in rural areas, was optional rather than obligatory even there, was kept for administrative purposes with no statistical data retained, and the urban offices did not know their own annual registered births . The same account records that no proper registration system or population census had been conducted before or since independence in 1991 . Nothing between those two dates is held, so whether the 2002 position still describes the system cannot be stated - only that nobody has reported a completeness figure since.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Address register	Eritrea does not appear on the postal union's list of countries operating a postcode system (reference). The Universal Postal Union's addressing reference, dated August 2026, does not list Eritrea among the countries that require or use a postal-code system, establishing that no national postcode system exists (reference). The document does not itself state whether any other national addressing scheme operates, and the base holds nothing else on the question — no street-naming programme, no digital addressing initiative and no geocoding of the population registers.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Business register	The statutory business register is still operated manually, with no registration website and clearance through six offices (assessment). An investment climate assessment records that Eritrea has no business-registration website and requires manual registration and clearance through six government offices (assessment). The register itself is statutory: a 2002 proclamation requires the trade ministry to establish and maintain a business information register covering trade, manufacturing, services, fisheries and commercial farming, specifying the fields collected, annual reporting obligations, penalties and judicial review (proclamation). A register that exists in law and on paper is a different thing from a digital one, and nothing on the base records the register being computerised or published.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register	The electoral law provides for a voter register, and nothing records one ever having been compiled (electoral law). The Eritrean electoral law establishes an independent electoral commission responsible for preparing and administering the voter register, issuing voting cards, and closing and publicly displaying the register for inspection (electoral law). The base holds no record of a national election held under it, no commission constituted and no register compiled. The hosted text of the law is itself undated. This is a register that exists as a statutory design and not as a system.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register	Land registration rests on the 1997 proclamation establishing the cadastral office, with no statement of its operational extent (proclamation). The 1997 land registration proclamation established the Cadastral Office under the land, water and environment ministry, responsible for registering all land, rights over land and transfers of property, following the 1994 change of tenure under which all land belongs to the state with allocable private rights (proclamation). The proclamation establishes the office and not the register's reach. The base holds no parcel count, no coverage figure and no statement that the register is held digitally.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The national laboratory built genomic sequencing capacity and applied it nationally to malaria and resistance surveillance for the first time (report). Eritrea's national health laboratory has built genomic sequencing capacity since 2024, training 15 professionals — 13 from the health ministry and two from agriculture — and applying the capability to malaria and antimicrobial-resistance surveillance for the first time nationally (report). The standing system is the National Health Information System under the minister's office, comprising health information, technology and system-development units with parallel structures at regional level, collecting from all health facilities by paper and electronic channels. The district platform reached about 40% of secondary-level and above facilities at the plan's writing. The base holds no later coverage figure, so that reading is five years old and the direction since is unknown.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Bids for an integrated tax administration system were invited in September 2023; no award or go-live has followed. 2023-09-07 - the finance ministry invited sealed bids for the supply, installation and configuration of an integrated tax administration system with its hardware and IT equipment, under a development bank governance-sector project . The scope is a full replacement, not an add-on: implementation services with training, change management and quality assurance; cleaning, validation and migration of legacy data from the current system; deployment from a main production site to other locations in the capital and to every inland revenue office in the zobas; data replication and business continuity for disaster recovery; and support under a service level agreement . Three years on, no contract award, go-live date or operating account is on the record. The procurement notice is the whole of what the base holds on tax administration systems for this country, and a tender with no reported outcome is what the value here rests on.	STALLED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	ASYCUDA World was inaugurated on 8 January 2026, replacing customs software dating from 2007, with the source code transferred to the government. 2026-01-08 – ASYCUDA World entered service , replacing customs software in use since 2007. UNDP supported the implementation and the source code was transferred in full to the Eritrean government, which is the part worth recording: the system is nationally held rather than run on the country's behalf. It is the only sectoral management information system on this ledger, and nothing states what it connects to – no revenue system, no business register and no trade single window appears for Eritrea.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The only operating government digital system on the base is an internal customs platform (account). Eritrea inaugurated a customs platform in January 2026, replacing a paper-based system operational since 2007, with full source-code transfer to the government, an intranet architecture connecting all customs stations independent of continuous internet access, solar-powered servers and a ten-month capacity-building programme (account). It serves customs officials, not the public. The standing external measurement is the 2024 United Nations e-government survey (technical appendix); its country-level index values for Eritrea are not in the text held, so the base names the measurement without carrying its numbers. No online government service a citizen could use is recorded anywhere on the base.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position with no citizen-facing service on the base

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The last assessment of sub-national office ICT found no computer at all in 25 of 55 sub-regional offices (sector note). A sector assessment recorded a central ministry local network and internet server, six regional offices and 30 of 55 sub-regional offices connected by dial-up modem, no computer at all in 25 of 55 sub-regional offices, and no systematic maintenance arrangement (sector note). It is the clearest authoritative assessment of ICT at sub-national government offices located, and it dates from 2002. Nothing later on the base measures the same thing. The direction of travel over twenty-four years is therefore not something the base can state, which is itself the finding.	NO CHANGE the only assessment on the base is more than two decades old
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	One agricultural expert system, described by the ministry as part of artificial intelligence, gives farmers guidance when extension workers are unavailable (account). The agriculture ministry's strategic information system division, established in 2019, includes an agricultural expert system that the ministry itself describes as part of artificial intelligence, used to give farmers guidance when extension workers are unavailable (account). It is the only documented instance of a named artificial-intelligence component inside an Eritrean sectoral management information system, and the account is the ministry's own with nothing testing its use or effect. The base holds no later statement of whether the system still runs.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and the only such system on the base
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Eri-Chat, an offline AI application built by a ministry developer, launched in April 2025 and was shown at an Asmara diplomatic event in October. 2025-11-01 — a profile of the developer Naod Goitom Isaac describes Eri-Chat, an offline AI application launched in April 2025 and shown to ambassadors and UN officials at an Asmara UN Day event on 24 October 2025. It works in English only; local-language support waits on training data the developer says does not exist in sufficient quantity. It is one application written by a single software developer at the Ministry of Information rather than a national programme, and it is the only AI system of any kind on this ledger.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	AI-generated war imagery circulated widely, met only by external fact-checking; no domestic law or takedown route exists (fact check). A fact-checking service documented AI-generated images and videos through 2026 — tanks entering Assab, the president pursued by a foreign army chief, troops surrendering — circulating from both pro-Ethiopian and pro-Eritrean accounts, drawing large engagement and inflaming war narratives (fact check). The response on the record is entirely external. Eritrea has no artificial-intelligence law, no national strategy and no regulator (review), and no data-protection authority to which a person depicted could complain (redetermination). There is no domestic mechanism of any kind on the base for identifying, labelling or removing synthetic media.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and the only response on the record is external
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	One technology hub is documented: a youth union training centre teaching electronics, programming and robotics (account). The Youth Innovation and Entrepreneurship Hub, established in 2023 by the national union of Eritrean youth and students, runs three levels of six-month technical training in electronics, Python, Scratch, robotics and soldering, primarily for students in grades 9 to 11 (account). It is the clearest documented operating technology hub in Eritrea, and it is a training centre rather than an incubator: nothing on the base records a company founded through it, investment placed or a product taken to market. No commercial or university-attached hub is recorded anywhere.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and one hub on the base
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A self-organised collective released five Tigrinya-language education applications built to the national curriculum, with no stated funding or distribution channel. 2026-08-15 — an interview carried by the state information ministry describes five applications from the Shambko Apps Group : literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools written against the national curriculum, with a stated plan to extend them to Eritrea's eight other national languages. The group is a private collective rather than a state programme. Nothing is stated about download counts, distribution channel or funding, and no hub, incubator, investor or company registration appears elsewhere on the ledger — so this is one collective on the record, not evidence of a startup base.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	One regional training reached 108 government employees in computer technology and networking, 63 of them women (report). A workers' confederation branch provided vocational training in computer technology and computer networking to 108 government employees and force members, 63 of them women, reported in November 2025 (report). It is the clearest documented evidence that digital training reaching government employees exists, and it is a regional activity rather than a permanent nationwide scheme; no standing instrument was located at the probe date. The 2005 education ICT policy requires training only for education-sector staff (policy). The base holds one course and no measure of civil-service digital skills.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and it records one regional activity, not a scheme

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	The engineering college showed 26 research papers and 29 demonstrations from 1,694 students, 39% of them women (report). Mai Nefhi College of Engineering and Technology held its engineering day in May 2026 under the theme of innovation for national development, showing 26 research papers and engineering solutions, 32 illustrations and 29 engineering demonstrations, from a college of 1,694 students of whom 39% are women, across five-year degree and three-year diploma programmes (report). The qualifications themselves are longstanding: the institute of technology, established in 2004 and restructured into autonomous colleges in 2018, offers computer engineering degrees and computer, communication and electrical technology diplomas (account). The base holds student numbers and event output, and no graduate count or employment destination.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	The state telecommunications provider runs a web complaint form for internet faults; no whole-of-government channel exists (complaint hub). The sole state telecommunications provider operates a live web form for internet-connectivity, website-access and web-application problems, with telephone and email alternatives (complaint hub). It is the clearest operational digital feedback channel located, and it is narrowly sector-specific. Nothing on the base records a government complaint portal, a service-standards charter or a published response record, and there is no freedom of information law under which an unanswered complaint could be pursued (review contribution). The base holds no volume of complaints made or resolved.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and the channel is one operator's, not government's
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides		NO EVIDENCE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The fourth Eritrea Population and Health Survey completed fieldwork in 9,794 households across all six regions, with the report due in 2026. 2026-05-08 — the National Statistics Office reported the fourth Eritrea Population and Health Survey complete: 9,794 households across 405 enumeration areas, a 98.4% household completion rate, and collection by computer-assisted personal interview . Around 400 tables over 20 chapters are drafted, with writing, printing and dissemination scheduled through 2026, so the fieldwork is finished and the published output is not. Technical support came from UNECA and an Oslo consultancy under the UNDP-led Joint Programme on Data for Development. It is the most substantial statistical work the base holds for Eritrea.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The statistics office compiled national accounts for 2023 and began collection for 2024, the only administrative statistical production the base records. 2026-05-08 — alongside the household survey, the National Statistics Office is reported to have compiled the 2023 national accounts and started data collection for 2024 . That is the whole of the ledger's evidence on statistics drawn from administrative sources, and it is second-hand: the accounts themselves are not on the base, and no statement of which administrative systems feed them appears either. No statistics law and no national strategy for the development of statistics is on record for Eritrea, so this production rests on the office's own practice.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National foundational digital ID	A named programme, pilot or vendor engagement for a foundational digital-ID system distinct from the passport/civil-registration base already on file.	not yet probed
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	A licensing decision, application, or a dated update to the Submarine Networks registry's coastal-state count.	not yet probed
Starlink satellite internet service	A licence application, refusal, or an updated Starlink coverage-map entry for Eritrea.	not yet probed
Mobile money / digital payments service	A named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot, or a central-bank statement on digital payments distinct from the cash-deposit ultimatum.	not yet probed
Data-protection law	A published data-protection bill, statute or regulator designation.	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence law and strategy	A published national AI strategy or draft, or any statute or regulation addressed to artificial intelligence.	2026-08-31
Electronic transactions and e-commerce framework	A proclamation, regulation or gazetted bill giving legal effect to electronic signatures, records or contracts.	2026-08-31
Freedom of information law	An adopted freedom of information or access to information proclamation, with a request procedure and an appeal route.	2026-08-31
Statistics law	An enacted statistical proclamation giving the national statistics office a statutory mandate.	2026-08-31
Public discussion of government policy	An independent publication, permitted civil-society body or public forum in which digital or data policy is argued.	2026-08-31
National address and postcode system	A national postcode or street-addressing scheme, or a government statement that one is being built.	2026-08-31
Voter register	A voter register compiled under the electoral law, or an electoral commission constituted to prepare one.	2026-08-31
Online government services	Any citizen-facing online government service — an application, payment, licence or record request completed online.	2026-08-31
Regional shared digital infrastructure	A signed interconnection, cable landing or regional infrastructure agreement naming Eritrea as a participant.	2026-08-31
Control of artificial-intelligence abuse	A domestic law, regulator, platform agreement or takedown route addressed to synthetic or manipulated media.	2026-08-31
National cybersecurity strategy	A published national cybersecurity strategy or the instrument adopting one, or a computer emergency response team's constitution or advisory record; a country profile states there is no public strategy, and the only incident on file is the government's own May 2024 announcement of an attack repelled, uncorroborated.	2025-01-01

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